AI Event Detection

Updated September 22, 2026 at 10:30 PM

REQUIRES ONE OF THE FOLLOWING LICENSES:

- LIC-CM-S/D-PREMIER-PLTFM-ESS/PREM
- LIC-CM-S/D-ENT-PLTFM-ESS/PREM

> **Note**
>
> Want live training on this topic? Attend our upcoming live webinar, 360° Risk Detection & In-Cab Corrections, on October 8, 2026 at 11 a.m. to 12 p.m. EDT. Register Now →

Samsara **AI Event Detection** uses the Samsara Dash Cam to help prevent safety events by detecting and automatically notifying you of unsafe driving behaviors. To get the most out of your configuration and before you enable AI event detection, review Dash Cam Position Recommendations and AI Detection Best Practices.

A safety event uploads to your Safety Inbox when your dash cam detects an AI event.

Notifications and Alerts

You can configure alerts that notify both you and the driver when a behavior has been detected:

- **Safety Alerts**: Configure an alert to receive an email notification or an SMS when a policy violation is detected.
- **In-Cab Audio Alerts** : Notify drivers when an AI event is detected. With in-cab alerts enabled, you can configure the following options:
    - **In-cab Nudges**: Notify drivers immediately upon detection, allowing them to address the issue before it affects their safety score or displays in the Safety Inbox. For information on the detection types available for Nudges, see In-Cab Nudges™ (Alerts).
    - **In-cab Alerts For Your Fleet**: Notify drivers when the behavior is detected by the dash cam. When enabled, the in-cab alert type (tone or voice-coaching) reflects the fleet-level configuration. To configure in-cab alerts for all vehicles in your fleet, enable the in-cab audio setting for the detection type when you Configure AI Event Detection.
    - **In-cab Alerts For Individual Vehicles**: Enable or disable In-Cab Audio Alerts and Voice Coaching for one or more vehicles (tone alerts are not available at the individual vehicle level).

AI Detection Types

The following list summarizes the available AI detection settings:

- Following Distance (Tailgating) Detection: Detects tailgating behavior where a driver is following another vehicle too closely.
- Forward Collision Warning: Detects when a vehicle comes within seconds of a forward collision.
- Lane Departure Warning: Detects when a vehicle crosses a solid yellow or white line.
- Distracted Driving Detections:
    - Mobile Usage Detection: Identifies when a driver is holding a mobile phone.
    - Drowsiness Detection: Identifies behaviors associated with fatigue.
    - Inattentive Driving Detection: Identifies patterns where driver attention is directed away from the road over a period of time.
- Railroad Crossing Violation Detection: Detects when a vehicle fails to stop at a mapped heavy rail crossing where a full stop is required.
- Policy Violations:
    - No Seat Belt Detection: Detects when the driver is not wearing a seat belt.
    - Inward Camera Obstruction: Detects when the camera view of the driver is obstructed at the beginning of the trip.

audio alerts to help reduce side-swipe risk during lane changes and merges.

When you enable any AI features that are in beta, you are confirming you have read the AI Beta Feature Disclaimer.

Dash Cam Position Recommendations and AI Detection Best Practices

To ensure optimal performance of AI event detection in your fleet, follow these general recommendations for dash cam positioning and best practices. For specific AI Detection Types, refer to the relevant topics for detailed recommendations.

Dash Cam Position Recommendations

Follow these steps to position your dash cam correctly for unobstructed and clear AI detection:

- **Ensure Unobstructed View**:
  - Keep the dash cam's line of sight to the driver and steering wheel clear.
  - Remove any hanging objects that obscure the driver's face, hands, and torso.
  - Advise the driver to remove any facial accessories, such as sunglasses or hats.
- **Proper Mounting**:
  - For inward-facing AI detection, mount the dash cam inside the windshield to prevent glares and refraction blurs.
  - Verify the mounting placement and ensure proper placement for AI Detection (see Test Camera Positioning).

AI Detection Best Practices

Implement these practices to ensure the effectiveness of AI event detection across your fleet:

- **Initial Testing**: For fleets with more than 250 vehicles, test the AI features on a subset of vehicles before enabling them fleet-wide. Assess the impact on the Safety Inbox and in-cab audio feedback.
- **Review and Feedback**: Monitor your Safety Inbox over the next week to evaluate event volume. If in-cab voice coaching is enabled, gather feedback from drivers to ensure the system is functioning effectively.

Configure AI Event Detection

When you configure AI event detection settings, you can apply the settings to your fleet or to individual vehicles. To configure settings for an individual vehicle, see Configure Safety Settings for Individual Vehicles or use the following workflow to configure settings for all vehicles in your fleet:

1. Select the Settings icon (⚙) at the bottom of your Fleet menu.
2. From within Fleet settings, navigate to **Safety > Event Detection > AI Event Detection**.
3. Configure the AI event setting for your organization. For detailed instructions, refer to the article for the AI detection type.
4. To configure in-cab audio alerts for your fleet and select the alert type (tone or voice coaching), configure the setting for In-Cab Audio Alerts and Voice Coaching.
5. **Submit** to save the changes.

Guided Resources

Watch the Adjust AI Event Sensitivity video to configure event sensitivity per event type (such as **Following Distance Detection**).